

China SMid Insurance

Marine Insurance: Onshore risk repatriation creates medium-term upside for China Re and China Taiping

China's seaborne trade has expanded rapidly over recent decades, alongside the build-out of domestic merchant fleet capacity, driving robust demand for marine insurance. More recently, regulators have introduced a suite of supportive policies and positioned Shanghai as a marine insurance hub, with the aim of strengthening China's independent domestic risk governance capabilities. The full marine insurance value chain, including underwriting capacity, reinsurance support, specialized clauses and cross-border dispute settlement, has long been dominated by London and other developed markets (For details, see [Asia Insurance: Summer Series: China's marine insurance: Strategic repatriation of maritime risk](#)). **China Re** is a key medium-term beneficiary, in our view, and is well positioned to capture upside from state-led initiatives focused on onshore risk repatriation. Compared with major peers, the stock offers a compelling risk-reward profile, trading at a 4x FY26E P/E with an 8% dividend yield, vs peers at 3-6%. **China Taiping** also has relevant P&C and reinsurance exposure that may benefit from policy catalysts, alongside expectations of strong life sales momentum in 1H26.

- **China's marine insurance development and current issues.** Marine insurance is a critical financial pillar for China's shipping and cross-border trade ecosystem. China has developed into a leading global maritime power, ranking at or near the top globally in shipbuilding output, cross-border cargo volumes and merchant fleet tonnage. However, China has historically relied on overseas reinsurers and insurers for marine insurance products, arbitration and claims services, creating potential supply chain security risks. Rising demand from green shipping, offshore wind transportation and Belt & Road maritime infrastructure further highlights the need for independent domestic underwriting capacity. In addition, the long-standing dominance of overseas markets has resulted in persistent premium outflows, accelerating policy-driven development of domestic marine insurance and reinsurance capabilities.
- **Policy support.** China's marine insurance industry is shifting from volume expansion towards higher-value, specialized risk services. In response, authorities are optimizing marine legal frameworks, digitizing claims settlement procedures and upgrading underwriting standards. **The revised Maritime Code, effective May 2026**, together with Shanghai's marine insurance guidance issued in October 2024, reinforces the city's role as a national pilot zone for maritime risk aggregation, allocation and governance. These developments should help reduce structural reliance on overseas risk transfer over time.
- **Stock positioning.** High technical underwriting barriers should sustain a concentrated market structure, which is favorable for **China Re**. As China's only national comprehensive reinsurance group, China Re leads the National Vessel Insurance Consortium and the Maritime Silk Road Consortium. We therefore expect leading domestic P&C insurers to retain more onshore marine risks while ceding more complex exposures to China Re, supporting steady and visible medium-term earnings growth. Alternatively, **China Taiping** also offers upside exposure to the domestic risk repatriation theme among insurers and manufacturers, given its long operating history as both a key non-life insurer and reinsurer (China Re/Taiping Re S&P credit rating: A(Stable)/A(Stable)).

Insurance

Dan Wang ^{AC}

(86-21) 6106-6349

dan.wang@jpmorgan.com

SAC Registration Number: S1730524080001

J.P. Morgan Securities (China) Company Limited

MW Kim

(852) 2800-8517

mw.kim@jpmorgan.com

J.P. Morgan Securities (Asia Pacific) Limited/
J.P. Morgan Broking (Hong Kong) Limited

Julia Kim

(852) 2800-8540

julia.c.kim@jpmorgan.com

J.P. Morgan Securities (Asia Pacific) Limited/
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Table 1: China policy support for Marine Insurance

Policy Category	Policy Name	Issuing Authority	Date	Core Policy Content
Hainan Free Trade Port Marine Insurance Policies	Provisions on Promoting Cross-border Financial Development in Hainan FTP (Draft for Comments)	Hainan Provincial Financial Affairs Office	Jun-26	1. Promote RMB pricing and settlement in insurance; 2. Attract domestic/foreign insurers to set up a presence in Hainan; 3. Focus on vessel and cargo marine insurance; 4. Integrate shipping finance leasing with insurance innovation
Belt and Road Initiatives (BRI) Marine Insurance Policies	Joint Notice on Promoting "Maritime Credit + Shipping Insurance"	Ministry of Transport & National Administration of Financial Regulation	Jun-26	1. Link maritime credit records with insurance pricing; 2. Simplify vessel insurance procedures; 3. Promote electronic policies and data interoperability; 4. Shift insurance focus from post-loss indemnity to pre-risk control
Hainan Free Trade Port Marine Insurance Policies	Opinions on Piloting High-Standard Institutional Opening-up in Financial Sector	PBOC, MOFCOM, NAFR, CSRC, SAFE	Jan-25	1. Shanghai and Hainan pilot financial opening-up reforms; 2. Foreign financial institutions receive national treatment; 3. Facilitate cross-border insurance services and capital flows; 4. Promote compliant cross-border financial data flows
Belt and Road Initiatives (BRI) Marine Insurance Policies	Action Plan for Strengthening Regulation, Preventing Risks and Boosting High-Quality Development of Property Insurance	National Administration of Financial Regulation (NAFR)	Dec-24	1. Accelerate shipping insurance development and expand underwriting capacity; 2. Strengthen export credit insurance for Chinese outbound investment; 3. Upgrade the BRI reinsurance consortium; 4. Explore insurance-investment integrated risk management models
Shanghai Free Trade Zone Marine Insurance Policies	Guiding Opinions on High-Quality Development of Shanghai Shipping Insurance Industry	National Administration of Financial Regulation (NAFR)	Oct-24	1. Enrich shipping insurance product offerings; 2. Consolidate domestic reinsurance underwriting capacity; 3. Improve global shipping insurance service standards; 4. Build a world-class shipping insurance center

Source: China regulatory authority including NAFR, PBOC, CSRC, SAFE etc.,

Table 2: Policy summary for promoting Shanghai's high-quality development of Marine Insurance

Policy Name	Date	Issuing Authority	Key Content
关于印发修订后的《中国(上海)自由贸易试验区临港新片区支持国际再保险功能区建设的若干措施》的通知 Revised Measures to Support the Development of the International Reinsurance Function Zone within the Lingang New Area of China (Shanghai) Pilot Free Trade Zone (Circular)	Aug-24	上海市人民政府 Shanghai Municipal People's Government	支持再保险机构和人才享受重点产业政策。对经国家金融监管部门批准并入驻功能区的保险公司、再保险公司、保险经纪公司等机构及其金融人才,给予落户奖励、增资奖励和人才奖励。Support insurance and reinsurance institutions settled in Lingang to enjoy key industrial policies. For insurance companies, reinsurance companies, marine insurance brokers and other relevant institutions and their financial talent that settle in Lingang Special Area, settlement subsidies, operation incentives and talent allowances will be provided.
提升上海航运服务业能级助力国际航运中心建设行动方案 Action Plan to Upgrade Shanghai's Shipping Service Capacity and Boost the Construction of the International Shipping Center	Jun-23	上海市人民政府 Shanghai Municipal People's Government	推动航运保险产品创新,探索研究对新能源船舶险、船舶建造险等重点险种的支持政策。Launch support policies covering shipping insurance products, and explore supportive policies targeting new energy-powered vessels and ship construction insurance.
提升上海航运服务业能级助力国际航运中心建设行动方案 Action Plan to Upgrade Shanghai's Shipping Service Capacity and Boost the Construction of the International Shipping Center	Jun-23	上海市人民政府 Shanghai Municipal People's Government	鼓励各类市场主体在民商事合同中选择上海作为争议解决地。支持境外仲裁和争议解决机构在上海设立机构并开展业务。鼓励海事仲裁机构参与国际海事争议解决规则、标准制定。Encourage all market entities to select Shanghai as the venue for resolving maritime commercial disputes. Support overseas arbitration and dispute resolution institutions to set up branches in Shanghai and carry out related businesses. Encourage maritime arbitration institutions to formulate localized rules aligned with international maritime dispute resolution standards.
关于促进洋山特殊综合保税区高能级航运服务产业发展的实施意见 Implementation Opinions on Promoting the High-quality Development of High-level Shipping Service Industry within the Yangshan Special Comprehensive Bonded Zone	May-24	上海市人民政府 Shanghai Municipal People's Government	支持电力、氢能、液化天然气、绿色甲醇、氨等新能源、清洁能源在航运业推广运用,加快推进行业绿色低碳转型。对符合条件的企业,加注甲醇、氨、绿电、氢能、液化天然气等清洁能源,按其清洁能源加注成本的20%予以支持,同一企业年度支持金额最高不超过1000万元。对提供甲醇、氨、液化天然气等清洁能源加注服务企业,按船舶购置成本给予适当奖励。Support the wide application of methanol, hydrogen, LNG, ammonia and other new clean energy sources in shipping industry, and accelerate the green low-carbon transformation of the industry. Subsidies covering 20% of vessel construction costs will be granted to eligible enterprises that build new vessels powered by methanol, hydrogen, LNG, ammonia and other clean energy; the maximum annual subsidy for a single enterprise shall not exceed Rmb10 million. Appropriate incentives will also be offered to shipping enterprises that deploy new energy-powered vessels fueled by methanol, LNG and other clean energy sources.
关于推动上海航运保险业高质量发展的指导意见 Guiding Opinions on Promoting the High-quality Development of Shanghai's Marine Insurance Industry	Oct-24	国家金融监督管理总局上海监管局,中共上海市委金融委员会办公室 NAFR Shanghai Bureau and CPC Shanghai Municipal Finance Committee Office	针对LNG船、甲醇船、纯电池船等绿色能源船舶和辅助驾驶等智能化船舶领域,多式联运、跨境电商、“中国制造”出口等物流贸易领域,智能码头、航运网络安全等基础设施领域,开发专业化、定制化的保险产品,逐步探索在新型风险领域率先建立行业标准和规范。Develop specialized, customized insurance products for LNG vessels, methanol vessels, lithium battery-powered vessels and other new energy vessels, as well as intelligent berthing, multi-modal transport, cross-border e-commerce and China manufacturing export cargo trade sectors; gradually formulate industry standards and norms for new risk-based insurance businesses.
关于推动上海航运保险业高质量发展的指导意见 Guiding Opinions on Promoting the High-quality Development of Shanghai's Marine Insurance Industry	Oct-24	国家金融监督管理总局上海监管局,中共上海市委金融委员会办公室 NAFR Shanghai Bureau and CPC Shanghai Municipal Finance Committee Office	鼓励辖内保险机构探索销售、承保、理赔、服务全流程数字化运营,优化业务流程,提升客户体验。把握航运贸易数字化趋势,运用区块链等技术,促进货运电子保单等电子单证使用推广。Encourage insurance institutions to build full digital operation systems covering sales, underwriting, claims settlement and customer service, so as to optimize business processes and improve customer experience. Seize the digital transformation trend of shipping trade, adopt blockchain technology to promote the application of electronic documents such as freight insurance electronic policies.

Source: National Administration of Financial Regulatory Shanghai Bureau, CPC Shanghai Municipal Finance Committee Office, Shanghai Municipal People's Government.

Companies Discussed in This Report (all prices in this report as of market close on 07 July 2026, unless otherwise indicated)

China Reinsurance Group - H(1508.HK/HK\$1.11/N), China Taiping Insurance - H(0966.HK/HK\$19.72/OW)

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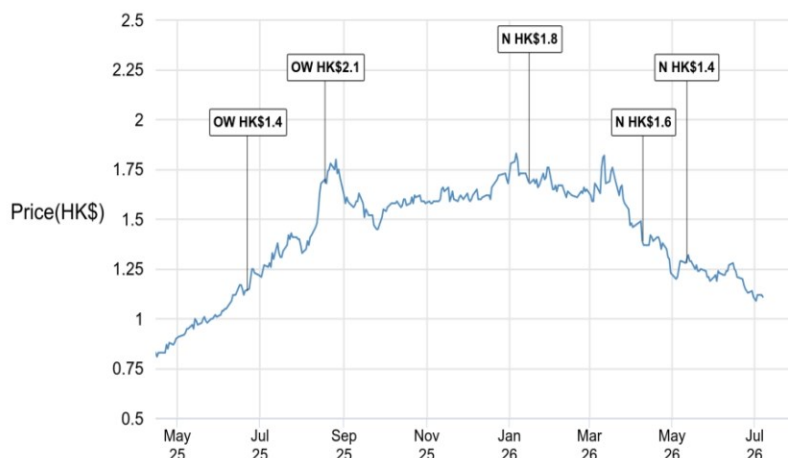
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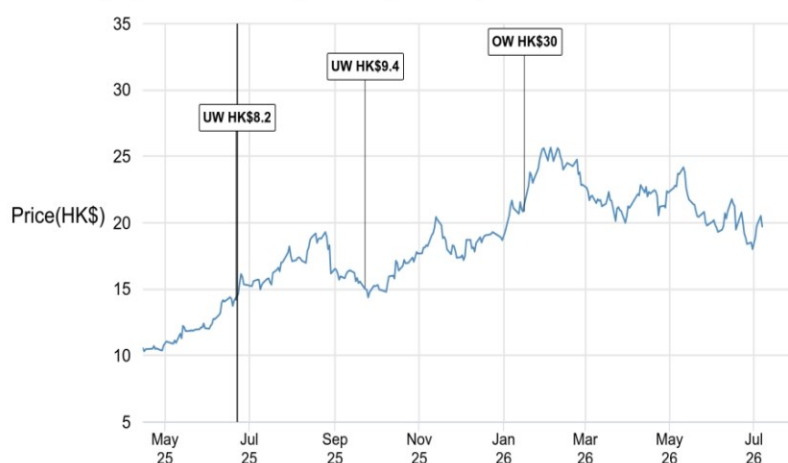
China Reinsurance Group - H (1508.HK, 1508 HK) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (HK\$)	Price Target (HK\$)
22-Jun-25	OW	1.14	1.4
18-Aug-25	OW	1.68	2.1
16-Jan-26	N	1.69	1.8
10-Apr-26	N	1.39	1.6
12-May-26	N	1.28	1.4

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Jun 22, 2025. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

China Taiping Insurance - H (0966.HK, 966 HK) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (HK\$)	Price Target (HK\$)
22-Jun-25	UW	14.14	8.2
23-Sep-25	UW	15.12	9.4
16-Jan-26	OW	20.84	30

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
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